22 Apr 2026 04:54:40 ET | 27 pages

Taiwan PCB & Laminates

ABF/CCL Price Hikes Likely in Sight; Rising Interest in CPU Concept

CITI'S TAKE

From marketing feedback, we sense investors' current sector preference: ABF/BT = CCL > PCB. Despite related names trading at high PE, investors seem to prefer holding their positions, awaiting price hike catalysts, unless there's any potential pull-back on macro uncertainties. Meanwhile, we were asked to discuss CPU concepts given growing CPU demand. Fundamentally, we remain bullish on ABF/BT and CCL sectors, given tight supply and likely price hikes. In PCB, despite potential oversupply risk, we still see upside potential in names with high tiering and less capacity expansion in SEA, such as Tripod and GCE. We reiterate Buy on Tripod on expanding CPU demand with less SEA capacity downside risk, and GCE as a tier-1 player exposed to higher ASIC/switch demand. For Zhen Ding (ZDT), we have a Sell rating given its high consumer exposure and aggressive capex. We open 30-day upside CW on Tripod given its upbeat 1Q26 sales.

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Hong Kong marketing feedback — Investors appeared to have high conviction in the ABF substrate sector and expect a price hike cycle on a quarterly basis starting from 2Q26 till 4Q27. For the CCL sector, investors we met with equally prefer this sector (vs substrate) given industry supply tightness; they also expect a price hike cycle on a quarterly basis starting from 2Q26 at least till 4Q26. For PCB, investors seemed to show rising concerns given the number of tier-2/3 PCB suppliers which claimed that they will start supplying AI server demand (especially for Nvidia's demand) from 2H26, potentially impacting tier-1 PCB players, which rely heavily on Nvidia. Also, given well-known ASIC/GPU concepts, we discussed potential beneficiaries of rising CPU demand for ABF/CCL/PCB.

Our latest views on CCL/PCB — We expect undersupply in the CCL sector, with roughly 20-30%/30-40% new capacity added industrywide in 2026E/27E. In our view, CCL price hikes on a quarterly basis should be feasible, though we have not seen one before (vs continued price hikes in 2020-22 in the ABF sector). We are not that concerned about oversupply in the PCB sector yet, given lower-than-expected output from SEA capacity, which needs monitoring continuously. However, given observed upstream bottlenecks (eg, foundry, CoWoS, HBM, substrate or CCL), we believe it is highly likely for the PCB sector to face production disruption (eg, delayed chip production) or CCL shortage some time in 2027, which would likely result in temporary oversupply of PCB capacity. At the moment, all PCB names claim CCL supply are guaranteed in the coming quarters, which is contradictory to current CCL capacity ramp industrywide. Despite the oversupply concern, we believe there is still upside potential in names with higher tier and less capacity expansion in SEA, such as Tripod and GCE, which, we believe, could weather through the disruption, as higher-tier PCB suppliers (with better yield control) should have higher priority in raw material supply vs lower-tier PCB peers. We suggest investors avoid PCB names that are 1) lower-tier suppliers with limited AI/regular server experience or 2) have greater capacity expansion in SEA (more inefficiency downside risk) vs in China. With this note, we also introduce 2028 estimates for GCE, Tripod and ZDT.

See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations.

Data Summary

						Rating		Short-Term	Target Price						Current Fiscal Year EPS		Next Fiscal Year EPS	
Company	Ticker	Ccy	Price	Mkt Cap (M)	Date & Time	Old	New	View	Old	New	ESPR (%)	Div Yld (%)	ETR (%)	Last Rpt Yr	Old	New	Old	New
Gold Circuit Electronics	2368.TW	NT$	1,250.00	638,162	22 Apr 13:30	1	nc	-	1,100.00	1,500.00	20.0	0.8	20.8	Dec-25	34.66	36.53	47.11	59.11
Tripod Technology	3044.TW	NT$	459.50	241,516	22 Apr 13:30	1	nc	Upside^	600.00	666.00	44.9	2.8	47.8	Dec-25	27.76	29.40	33.34	37.47
Zhen Ding Technology	4958.TW	NT$	315.00	337,238	22 Apr 13:30	3	nc	-	150.00	180.00	-42.9	1.2	-41.7	Dec-24	9.26	7.68	11.91	10.97

1 = Buy, 2 = Neutral, 3 = Sell, H = High Risk

ESPR = Expected Share Price Return, ETR = Expected Total Return, nc = no change

Source: Citi Research

^Catalyst Watch

Earnings Estimates

				Last Reported Year					Current Fiscal Year					Next Fiscal Year				
Company Name	Ticker	Last Rpt Year	Currency	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	FY0	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	FY1	1Q	2Q	3Q	4Q	FY2
Gold Circuit Electronics	2368.TW	Dec-25	NT$	3.46	3.35	6.38	5.79	18.98	6.69	8.50	10.61	10.72	36.53	12.43	13.63	16.53	16.52	59.11
Old		Dec-24	NT$	2.41	3.01	3.16	2.54	11.11	3.46	3.35	6.38	5.79	18.98	6.17	8.19	10.11	10.20	34.66
Tripod Technology	3044.TW	Dec-25	NT$	4.48	4.65	5.62	4.70	19.45	6.14	6.39	8.25	8.63	29.40	7.46	8.78	11.06	10.17	37.47
Old		Dec-25	NT$	4.48	4.65	5.62	5.40	20.15	5.77	6.12	8.02	7.85	27.76	6.23	7.85	10.21	9.05	33.34
Zhen Ding Technology	4958.TW	Dec-24	NT$	1.03	0.51	3.51	3.96	9.04	0.66	0.63	2.30	3.82	7.68	0.89	0.87	3.76	5.46	10.97
Old		Dec-24	NT$	1.03	0.51	3.51	3.96	9.04	0.66	0.63	3.60	4.37	9.26	1.27	1.14	4.22	5.29	11.91

Source: Citi Research

Tripod (Buy): hidden gem in expanding CPU market; higher TP NT$666 — Tripod's 1Q26 sales tracked 7% above our initial/consensus forecasts, which echoes our investment thesis of a beneficiary of memory and server demand (for either AI server or general-purpose server). Before the AI boom, the company had at least 30% m/s in CPU mainboard for general-purpose server (vs GCE's m/s of 30%+). Given GCE's heavier focus on AI ASIC mainboard now, we believe Tripod could see more outflowing orders from AI GPU/ASIC mainboard players. We also believe it could secure CCL supply given its good track record in the server/memory market and its larger scale vs other peers. Further, we see limited downside to its operation, as Tripod is the most conservative company in SEA capacity expansion, which was also likely why it wasn't favored by investors in the past. However, looking forward, it has flexibility in brownfield capacity expansion in China, to fulfill upcoming AI or CPU mainboard demand. We believe the name could benefit from CPU trend, hence warrant a re-rating; we thus raise our DCF-based TP to NT$666 from NT$600 as we see a stronger sales/margin outlook driven by growth from memory/server. Currently, the name is trading at unstretched 15x 2026E EPS vs other CCL/PCB names at 25-30x on 2027BBG EPS. **We also open a 30-day upside Catalyst Watch on Tripod ahead of upcoming 1Q26 results on May 8th.**

GCE (Buy): the leading player in ASIC and switch; higher TP NT$1,500 — We believe GCE's leading position could help it secure CCL supply and allow it to benefit more from rising 800G switch penetration (higher ASP). We see the company making efforts to increase capacity via either leased plants or debottlenecking to capture more demand. We expect AWS demand to start ramping from 3Q26E, with Google demand likely followed in 4Q26E. We raise our '26/27E earnings on higher ASIC/switch contribution, with a higher TP of NT$1,500 (25x 2027E EPS) from NT$1,100 (25x 2H26-2027E EPS).

ZDT (Sell): likely headwinds ahead; TP NT$180 — We believe ZDT's YTD share price outperformance (vs its subsidiary, Avary Holding) was mostly driven by the ABF sector re-rating (c.5% sales mix). We are bullish on its ABF segment, with our only-one mild concern over its T glass supply (ie, low priority to upstream suppliers). However, we note its aggressive capex investment (guidance NT$80bn/50bn/50bn for 2026/27/28), as at least CCL supply would become a major concern for this name (a tier-2 RPCB name + aggressive investment in SEA + limited AI server experience). We agree that ZDT has a good execution track record in the iPhone/Mac business. However, high consumer electronics exposure (80-90% sales mix) and a rising depreciation burden suggest it is prone to GM dilution, if there is any delay in AI chip ramp-up or CCL supply constraints. We adjust our 2026E/27E earnings by+3%/+3%. We maintain Sell with a higher TP of NT$180 (vs. NT$150 previously) as we see a stronger sales growth outlook on stronger expansion. Our DCF-based TP of NT$180 implies 13x 2027E EPS.

Figure 1. Tripod – 1Q26 Results Preview

(NT$mn)	1Q26 Citi	4Q25 Actual	Q/Q	1Q25 Actual	Y/Y	1Q26 Cons.	Diff.
Revenue	20,964	18,979	10%	17,128	22%	19,554	7%
Gross profit	5,747	4,834	19%	4,276	34%	5,115	12%
Gross margin	27.4%	25.5%	+1.9 ppt	25.0%	+2.4 ppt	26.2%	+1.3 ppt
Op. profit	3,976	3,242	23%	2,851	39%	3,616	10%
OP margin	19.0%	17.1%	+1.9 ppt	16.6%	+2.3 ppt	18.5%	+0.5 ppt
Net income	3,225	2,471	31%	2,356	37%	2,924	10%
EPS (NT$)	6.14	4.70	31%	4.48	37%	5.56	10%

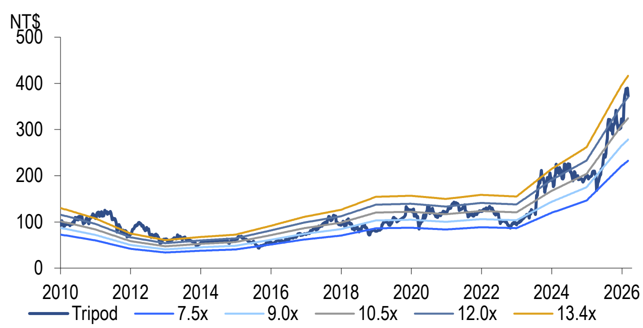
Source: Citi Research Estimates, Bloomberg, Company reports

Figure 2. Tripod – Earnings Revisions

	1Q26E			2Q26E			2026E			2027E			2028E
(NT$mn)	New	Old	Chg.	New	Old	Chg.	New	Old	Chg.	New	Old	Chg.	New
Sales	20,964	19,610	7%	21,863	20,858	5%	90,205	86,258	5%	104,733	96,503	9%	119,308
Sequential growth (%)	10%	3%		4%	6%		23%	18%		16%	12%		14%
Gross profit	5,747	5,381	7%	6,146	5,868	5%	26,455	25,002	6%	33,121	29,593	12%	38,988
Opex	1,771	1,657	7%	1,761	1,681	5%	7,274	6,955	5%	8,396	7,734	9%	9,416
Operating profit	3,976	3,724	7%	4,385	4,187	5%	19,182	18,047	6%	24,725	21,859	13%	29,572
Pre-tax profit	4,244	3,992	6%	4,667	4,469	4%	20,320	19,189	6%	25,918	23,057	12%	30,745
Net income	3,225	3,034	6%	3,361	3,218	4%	15,455	14,593	6%	19,694	17,524	12%	23,353
EPS (NT$)	6.14	5.77	6%	6.39	6.12	4%	29.40	27.76	6%	37.47	33.34	12%	44.43
Gross margin (%)	27.4%	27.4%	-0.0 ppt	28.1%	28.1%	-0.0 ppt	29.3%	29.0%	+0.3 ppt	31.6%	30.7%	+1.0 ppt	32.7%
Opex ratio (%)	8.5%	8.5%	-0.0 ppt	8.1%	8.1%	-0.0 ppt	8.1%	8.1%	+0.0 ppt	8.0%	8.0%	+0.0 ppt	7.9%
Operating margin (%)	19.0%	19.0%	-0.0 ppt	20.1%	20.1%	-0.0 ppt	21.3%	20.9%	+0.3 ppt	23.6%	22.7%	+1.0 ppt	24.8%
Net margin (%)	15.4%	15.5%	-0.1 ppt	15.4%	15.4%	-0.1 ppt	17.1%	16.9%	+0.2 ppt	18.8%	18.2%	+0.6 ppt	19.6%

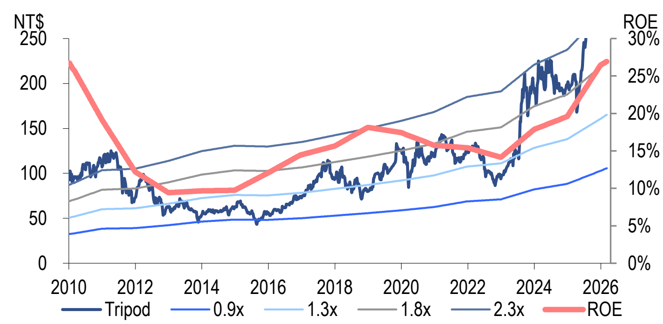
Source: Citi Research Estimates

Figure 3. Tripod – 12M Forward P/E Band



Source: dataCentral, Citi Research

Figure 4. Tripod – 12M Forward P/B Band



Source: dataCentral, Citi Research

Figure 5. Tripod – Forecast Summary

Tripod	2026				2027															
(NT$ in Mn, year-end Dec)	1QE	2QE	3QE	4QE	1QE	2QE	3QE	4QE	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenue	20,964	21,863	23,501	23,877	23,348	25,852	29,001	26,533	52,106	54,451	55,548	63,000	65,784	58,862	65,804	73,399	90,205	104,733	119,308
COGS	-15,217	-15,717	-16,413	-16,403	-16,441	-17,701	-19,626	-17,844	-42,341	-43,185	-44,397	-51,101	-53,979	-47,476	-50,516	-54,407	-63,750	-71,612	-80,320
Gross Profit	5,747	6,146	7,088	7,474	6,907	8,151	9,375	8,689	9,764	11,266	11,150	11,899	11,805	11,387	15,288	18,992	26,455	33,121	38,988
Operating Expense	-1,771	-1,761	-1,820	-1,921	-2,031	-2,041	-2,229	-2,095	-4,343	-4,495	-4,576	-5,286	-5,036	-4,763	-5,557	-6,080	-7,274	-8,396	-9,416
SG&A expenses	-1,677	-1,665	-1,717	-1,816	-1,915	-1,912	-2,084	-1,962	-4,160	-4,290	-4,352	-5,075	-4,796	-4,513	-5,275	-5,774	-6,875	-7,873	-8,820
R&D expenses	-94	-96	-103	-105	-117	-129	-145	-133	-183	-205	-224	-211	-240	-250	-282	-307	-399	-524	-597
EBIT	3,976	4,385	5,267	5,553	4,875	6,110	7,146	6,594	5,422	6,771	6,574	6,613	6,769	6,624	9,731	12,912	19,182	24,725	29,572
Net Interest Income	192	206	206	210	197	216	221	215	163	183	188	211	73	477	916	742	814	849	829
Net Other Income	76	76	86	86	86	86	86	86	941	844	995	674	983	977	350	344	324	344	344
Pre-Tax Profit	4,244	4,667	5,559	5,850	5,158	6,412	7,453	6,896	6,525	7,798	7,757	7,498	7,825	8,077	10,996	13,998	20,320	25,918	30,745
Tax	1,018	1,307	1,223	1,316	1,238	1,795	1,640	1,551	-1,587	-1,761	-1,631	-1,639	-1,624	-2,015	-2,614	-3,773	-4,864	-6,224	-7,392
Net Profit	3,225	3,361	4,336	4,533	3,920	4,617	5,813	5,344	4,938	6,037	6,126	5,858	6,200	6,062	8,382	10,225	15,455	19,694	23,353
EPS (NT$)	6.14	6.39	8.25	8.63	7.46	8.78	11.06	10.17	9.40	11.49	11.65	11.15	11.80	11.53	15.95	19.45	29.40	37.47	44.43
Margins (%)																			
Gross Margin	27.4	28.1	30.2	31.3	29.6	31.5	32.3	32.7	18.7	20.7	20.1	18.9	17.9	19.3	23.2	25.9	29.3	31.6	32.7
Operating Margin	19.0	20.1	22.4	23.3	20.9	23.6	24.6	24.9	10.4	12.4	11.8	10.5	10.3	11.3	14.8	17.6	21.3	23.6	24.8
Net Margin	15.4	15.4	18.5	19.0	16.8	17.9	20.0	20.1	9.5	11.1	11.0	9.3	9.4	10.3	12.7	13.9	17.1	18.8	19.6
Sequential Growth (%)																			
Revenue	10.5	4.3	7.5	1.6	-2.2	10.7	12.2	-8.5	13.7	4.5	2.0	13.4	4.4	-10.5	11.8	11.5	22.9	16.1	13.9
Gross Profit	18.9	6.9	15.3	5.4	-7.6	18.0	15.0	-7.3	16.9	15.4	-1.0	6.7	-0.8	-3.5	34.3	24.2	39.3	25.2	17.7
EBIT	22.6	10.3	20.1	5.4	-12.2	25.3	17.0	-7.7	13.0	24.9	-2.9	0.6	2.4	-2.1	46.9	32.7	48.6	28.9	19.6
Net Profit	30.5	4.2	29.0	4.6	-13.5	17.8	25.9	-8.1	13.1	22.3	1.5	-4.4	5.8	-2.2	38.3	22.0	51.2	27.4	18.6
EPS	30.5	4.2	29.0	4.6	-13.5	17.8	25.9	-8.1	13.1	22.3	1.5	-4.4	5.8	-2.2	38.3	22.0	51.2	27.4	18.6

Source: Citi Research Estimates, Company Reports

Figure 6. GCE – 1Q26 Results Preview

(NT$mn)	1Q26 Citi	4Q25 Actual	Q/Q	1Q25 Actual	Y/Y	1Q26 Cons.	Diff.
Revenue	19,342	16,408	18%	12,063	60%	18,259	6%
Gross profit	6,796	5,524	23%	3,776	80%	6,262	9%
Gross margin	35.1%	33.7%	+1.5 ppt	31.3%	+3.8 ppt	34.3%	+0.8 ppt
Op. profit	5,088	3,987	28%	2,543	100%	4,648	9%
OP margin	26.3%	24.3%	+2.0 ppt	21.1%	+5.2 ppt	25.5%	+0.8 ppt
Net income	3,385	2,931	16%	1,753	93%	3,154	7%
EPS (NT$)	6.69	5.79	16%	3.46	93%	6.45	4%

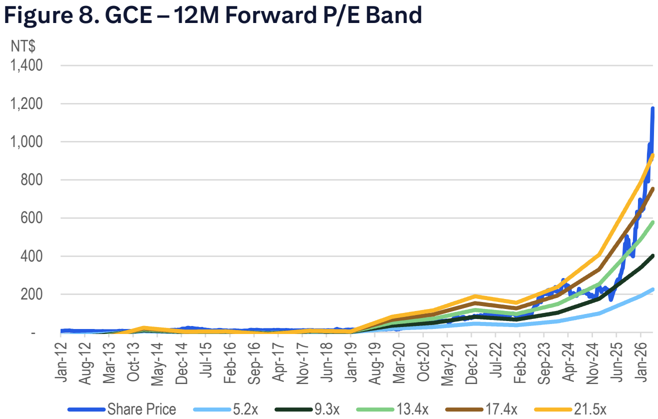
Source: Citi Research Estimates, Bloomberg, Company reports

Figure 7. GCE – Earnings Revisions

	1Q26E			2Q26E			2026E			2027E			2028E
(NT$mn)	New	Old	Chg.	New	Old	Chg.	New	Old	Chg.	New	Old	Chg.	New
Sales	19,342	18,038	7%	22,478	21,939	2%	94,210	90,827	4%	136,636	116,613	17%	176,317
Sequential growth (%)	18%	10%		16%	22%		57%	51%		45%	28%		29%
Gross profit	6,796	6,314	8%	8,212	8,011	3%	34,792	33,515	4%	54,074	44,732	21%	72,108
Opex	1,708	1,625	5%	1,923	1,910	1%	7,860	7,707	2%	10,846	9,703	12%	13,913
Operating profit	5,088	4,689	9%	6,289	6,101	3%	26,931	25,808	4%	43,227	35,029	23%	58,195
Pre-tax profit	5,129	4,730	8%	6,327	6,139	3%	27,103	25,980	4%	43,549	35,351	23%	58,517
Net income	3,385	3,122	8%	4,302	4,144	4%	18,484	17,541	5%	29,911	23,841	25%	40,164
EPS (NT$)	6.69	6.17	8%	8.50	8.19	4%	36.53	34.66	5%	59.11	47.11	25%	79.37
Gross margin (%)	35.1%	35.0%	+0.1 ppt	36.5%	36.5%	+0.0 ppt	36.9%	36.9%	+0.0 ppt	39.6%	38.4%	+1.2 ppt	40.9%
Opex ratio (%)	8.8%	9.0%	-0.2 ppt	8.6%	8.7%	-0.2 ppt	8.3%	8.5%	-0.1 ppt	7.9%	8.3%	-0.4 ppt	7.9%
Operating margin (%)	26.3%	26.0%	+0.3 ppt	28.0%	27.8%	+0.2 ppt	28.6%	28.4%	+0.2 ppt	31.6%	30.0%	+1.6 ppt	33.0%
Net margin (%)	17.5%	17.3%	+0.2 ppt	19.1%	18.9%	+0.3 ppt	19.6%	19.3%	+0.3 ppt	21.9%	20.4%	+1.4 ppt	22.8%

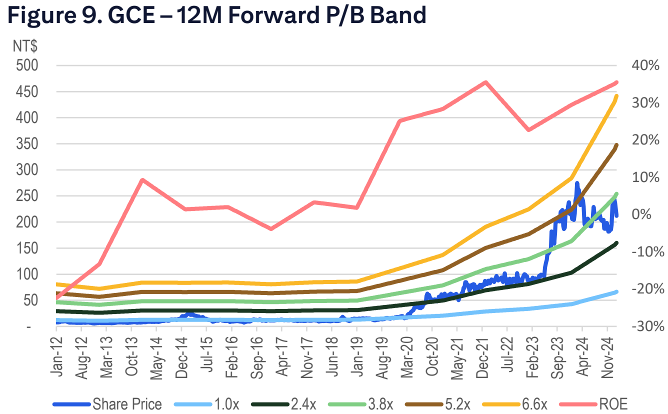
Source: Citi Research Estimates

Figure 8. GCE – 12M Forward P/E Band



Source: dataCentral, Citi Research

Figure 9. GCE – 12M Forward P/B Band



Source: dataCentral, Citi Research

Figure 10. GCE – Forecast Summary

GCE (NT$ in Mn, year-end Dec)	2026 1QE	2QE	3QE	4QE	2027 1QE	2QE	3QE	4QE	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenue	19,342	22,478	26,440	25,950	31,154	32,668	36,506	36,308	19,166	20,596	18,991	23,398	26,607	32,785	30,044	38,952	60,004	94,210	136,636	176,317
COGS	-12,546	-14,266	-16,594	-16,013	-19,097	-20,023	-21,792	-21,651	-17,283	-17,596	-16,500	-18,108	-20,236	-24,057	-22,320	-27,556	-40,321	-59,419	-82,563	-104,209
Depreciation costs	-469	-599	-752	-906	-1,080	-1,230	-1,341	-1,453	-942	-887	-754	-615	-653	-743	-821	-960	-1,195	-2,725	-5,104	-6,343
Gross Profit	6,796	8,212	9,846	9,937	12,058	12,645	14,714	14,657	1,883	3,000	2,491	5,291	6,371	8,728	7,724	11,396	19,683	34,792	54,074	72,108
Operating Expense	-1,708	-1,923	-2,109	-2,121	-2,615	-2,581	-2,851	-2,799	-1,963	-2,226	-1,821	-2,217	-2,249	-2,691	-2,588	-3,329	-5,640	-7,860	-10,846	-13,913
SG&A expenses	-1,373	-1,529	-1,639	-1,661	-2,087	-2,025	-2,263	-2,251	-1,404	-1,462	-1,285	-1,575	-1,673	-1,948	-1,866	-2,342	-4,430	-6,202	-8,627	-11,130
R&D expenses	-367	-427	-502	-493	-561	-588	-621	-581	-420	-474	-471	-533	-623	-718	-803	-974	-1,256	-1,790	-2,350	-2,914
EBIT	5,088	6,289	7,738	7,816	9,442	10,064	11,863	11,858	-80	774	669	3,074	4,123	6,037	5,136	8,067	14,043	26,931	43,227	58,195
Net Interest Income	28	26	34	34	58	66	74	74	-219	-258	-213	-147	-51	-27	78	78	55	122	272	272
Net Other Income	13	12	13	12	13	12	13	12	37	-196	-186	-229	-23	379	3	345	75	50	50	50
Pre-Tax Profit	5,129	6,327	7,785	7,862	9,513	10,142	11,950	11,944	-263	320	270	2,698	4,049	6,388	5,218	8,490	14,173	27,103	43,549	58,517
Tax	-1,744	-2,025	-2,413	-2,437	-3,225	-3,246	-3,585	-3,583	-6	-92	-140	-631	-1,122	-1,820	-1,689	-2,875	-4,567	-8,619	-13,639	-18,353
Net Profit	3,385	4,302	5,371	5,425	6,288	6,897	8,365	8,361	-269	229	130	2,067	2,927	4,568	3,529	5,616	9,607	18,484	29,911	40,164
EPS (NT$)	6.69	8.50	10.61	10.72	12.43	13.63	16.53	16.52	-0.50	0.42	0.24	3.81	5.40	8.80	7.23	11.11	18.98	36.53	59.11	79.37
Sequential Growth (%)																				
Networking	18%	-9%	2%	0%	39%	-2%	3%	0%	-12%	42%	-30%	18%	3%	30%	-25%	12%	59%	76%	37%	28%
Server	18%	24%	22%	-1%	19%	6%	14%	0%	-7%	5%	8%	28%	11%	48%	-3%	40%	67%	59%	51%	32%
NB	19%	20%	14%	-9%	-10%	12%	14%	-2%	23%	-12%	-8%	12%	25%	-16%	-13%	-15%	25%	24%	9%	0%
Others	12%	15%	1%	-12%	1%	12%	1%	-12%	14%	-6%	-8%	41%	28%	-32%	3%	83%	-29%	10%	1%	0%
Margins (%)																				
Gross Margin	35.1%	36.5%	37.2%	38.3%	38.7%	38.7%	40.3%	40.4%	9.8%	14.6%	13.1%	22.6%	23.9%	26.6%	25.7%	29.3%	32.8%	36.9%	39.6%	40.9%
Operating Margin	26.3%	28.0%	29.3%	30.1%	30.3%	30.8%	32.5%	32.7%	-0.4%	3.8%	3.5%	13.1%	15.5%	18.4%	17.1%	20.7%	23.4%	28.6%	31.6%	33.0%
Net Margin	17.5%	19.1%	20.3%	20.9%	20.2%	21.1%	22.9%	23.0%	-1.4%	1.1%	0.7%	8.8%	11.0%	13.9%	11.7%	14.4%	16.0%	19.6%	21.9%	22.8%
Sequential Growth (%)																				
Revenue	18%	16%	18%	-2%	20%	5%	12%	-1%	0%	7%	-8%	23%	14%	23%	-8%	30%	54%	57%	45%	29%
Gross Profit	23%	21%	20%	1%	21%	5%	16%	0%	-28%	59%	-17%	112%	20%	37%	-12%	48%	73%	77%	55%	33%
EBIT	28%	24%	23%	1%	21%	7%	18%	0%	-111%	-1066%	-13%	359%	34%	46%	-15%	57%	74%	92%	61%	35%
Net Profit	16%	27%	25%	1%	16%	10%	21%	0%	-287%	-185%	-43%	1493%	42%	56%	-23%	59%	71%	92%	62%	34%
EPS	16%	27%	25%	1%	16%	10%	21%	0%	-289%	-185%	-43%	1490%	42%	63%	-18%	54%	71%	92%	62%	34%

Source: Citi Research Estimates, Company Reports

Figure 11. ZDT – 1Q26 Results Preview

(NT$mn)	1Q26 Citi	4Q25 Actual	Q/Q	1Q25 Actual	Y/Y	1Q26 Cons.	Diff.
Revenue	40,728	56,870	-28%	40,082	2%	40,925	0%
Gross profit	6,539	12,830	-49%	5,885	11%	6,756	-3%
Gross margin	16.1%	22.6%	-6.5 ppt	14.7%	+1.4 ppt	16.5%	-0.5 ppt
Op. profit	1,693	5,921	-71%	1,056	60%	1,474	15%
OP margin	4.2%	10.4%	-6.3 ppt	2.6%	+1.5 ppt	3.6%	+0.6 ppt
Net income	952	4,094	-77%	632	51%	948	0%
EPS (NT$)	0.89	3.82	-77%	0.66	35%	0.93	-4%

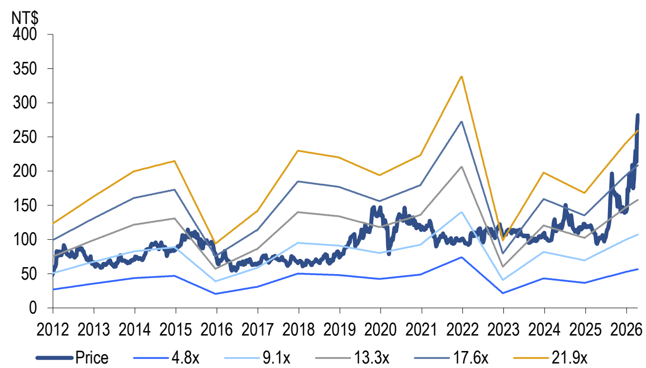
Source: Citi Research Estimates, Bloomberg, Company reports

Figure 12. ZDT – Earnings Revisions

(NT$mn)	1Q26E New	1Q26E Old	1Q26E Chg.	2Q26E New	2Q26E Old	2Q26E Chg.	2026E New	2026E Old	2026E Chg.	2027E New	2027E Old	2027E Chg.	2028E New
Sales	40,728	39,602	3%	41,684	40,831	2%	205,104	195,656	5%	248,121	212,884	17%	293,631
Sequential growth (%)	-28%	-28%		2%	3%		12%	8%		21%	9%		18%
Gross profit	6,539	6,388	2%	6,828	7,537	-9%	42,591	42,063	1%	54,183	48,646	11%	67,906
Opex	4,847	4,277	13%	5,044	5,349	-6%	23,614	22,515	5%	27,451	23,758	16%	31,036
Operating profit	1,693	2,111	-20%	1,784	2,188	-18%	18,977	19,548	-3%	26,732	24,888	7%	36,871
Pre-tax profit	2,063	2,281	-10%	2,175	2,360	-8%	20,470	20,282	1%	27,136	25,292	7%	37,274
Net income	952	1,215	-22%	927	1,089	-15%	11,749	11,396	3%	14,773	14,291	3%	20,324
EPS (NT$)	0.89	1.27	-30%	0.87	1.14	-24%	10.97	11.91	-8%	13.80	14.94	-8%	18.98
Gross margin (%)	16.1%	16.1%	-0.1 ppt	16.4%	18.5%	-2.1 ppt	20.8%	21.5%	-0.7 ppt	21.8%	22.9%	-1.0 ppt	23.1%
Opex ratio (%)	11.9%	10.8%	+1.1 ppt	12.1%	13.1%	-1.0 ppt	11.5%	11.5%	+0.0 ppt	11.1%	11.2%	-0.1 ppt	10.6%
Operating margin (%)	4.2%	5.3%	-1.2 ppt	4.3%	5.4%	-1.1 ppt	9.3%	10.0%	-0.7 ppt	10.8%	11.7%	-0.9 ppt	12.6%
Net margin (%)	2.3%	3.1%	-0.7 ppt	2.2%	2.7%	-0.4 ppt	5.7%	5.8%	-0.1 ppt	6.0%	6.7%	-0.8 ppt	6.9%

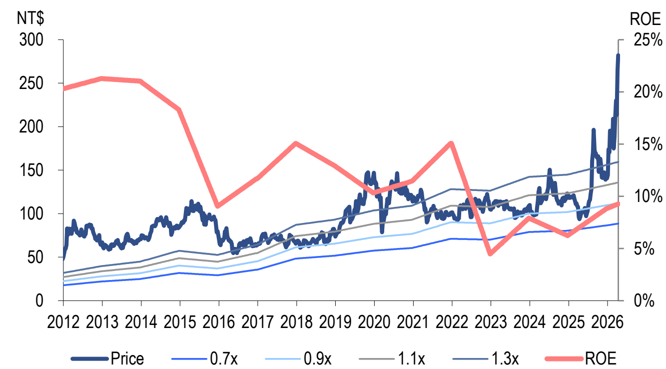
Source: Citi Research Estimates

Figure 13. ZDT – 12M Forward P/E Band



Source: dataCentral, Citi Research

Figure 14. ZDT – 12M Forward P/B Band



Source: dataCentral, Citi Research

Figure 15. ZDT – Forecast Summary

ZDT (NT$ in Mn, year-end Dec)	2026 1QE	2026 2QE	2026 3QE	2026 4QE	2027 1QE	2027 2QE	2027 3QE	2027 4QE
Revenue	40,728	41,684	56,879	65,813	48,923	54,520	67,711	76,966
COGS	-34,188	-34,856	-43,683	-49,786	-40,285	-43,564	-51,982	-58,107
Gross Profit	6,539	6,828	13,196	16,027	8,639	10,956	15,729	18,859
Operating Expense	-4,847	-5,044	-6,484	-7,239	-5,088	-6,815	-7,313	-8,235
SG&A expenses	-2,403	-2,334	-2,844	-3,291	-2,740	-2,890	-3,318	-3,771
R&D expenses	-2,444	-2,709	-3,640	-3,949	-2,348	-3,925	-3,995	-4,464
EBIT	1,693	1,784	6,712	8,788	3,551	4,141	8,417	10,624
Net Interest Income	150	170	145	145	-130	-130	-90	-90
Net Other Income	220	221	221	222	210	211	211	212
Pre-Tax Profit	2,063	2,175	7,078	9,155	3,631	4,222	8,537	10,746
Tax	722	870	1,416	915	1,089	1,267	1,964	2,009
Net Profit	952	927	4,020	5,850	1,805	2,098	4,667	6,203
EPS (NT$)	0.89	0.87	3.76	5.46	1.69	1.96	4.36	5.79
EPS (NT$) - diluted	0.89	0.87	3.76	5.46	1.69	1.96	4.36	5.79
Margins (%)								
Gross Margin	16.1	16.4	23.2	24.4	17.7	20.1	23.2	24.5
Operating Margin	4.2	4.3	11.8	13.4	7.3	7.6	12.4	13.8
Net Margin	2.3	2.2	7.1	8.9	3.7	3.8	6.9	8.1
Sequential Growth (%)								
Revenue	(28)	2	36	16	(26)	11	24	14
Gross Profit	(49)	4	93	21	(46)	27	44	20
EBIT	(71)	5	276	31	(60)	17	103	26
Net Profit	(77)	(3)	334	46	(69)	16	122	33
EPS (NT$)	(77)	(3)	334	46	(69)	16	122	33
EPS (NT$) - diluted	(77)	(3)	334	46	(69)	16	122	33

ZDT (NT$ in Mn, year-end Dec)	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenue	82,393	109,238	117,913	120,068	131,279	155,022	171,356	151,398	171,664	182,522	205,104	248,121	293,631
COGS	-69,851	-91,404	-91,852	-92,845	-104,694	-124,485	-131,468	-123,939	-139,203	-146,385	-162,514	-193,938	-225,724
Gross Profit	12,542	17,833	26,061	27,222	26,584	30,537	39,888	27,459	32,461	36,136	42,591	54,183	67,906
Operating Expense	-7,925	-9,176	-11,215	-12,421	-12,444	-14,756	-17,441	-18,300	-20,875	-22,205	-23,614	-27,451	-31,036
SG&A expenses	-4,160	-4,451	-5,578	-6,281	-6,898	-7,454	-9,162	-8,634	-9,160	-10,398	-10,872	-12,718	-13,829
R&D expenses	-3,765	-4,725	-5,638	-6,140	-5,545	-7,302	-8,280	-9,665	-11,715	-11,807	-12,742	-14,733	-17,207
EBIT	4,617	8,657	14,846	14,801	14,140	15,781	22,447	9,160	11,586	13,932	18,977	26,732	36,871
Net Interest Income	-27	4	149	574	250	-199	-113	575	601	374	610	-440	-440
Net Other Income	717	-167	-328	-424	-596	637	1,135	313	2,858	-243	884	844	844
Pre-Tax Profit	5,307	8,494	14,667	14,951	13,794	16,219	23,469	10,048	15,045	14,063	20,470	27,136	37,274
Tax	-1,851	-1,722	-3,130	-2,549	-2,286	-2,524	-2,524	-2,524	-2,524	-2,524	-3,923	-6,329	-8,649
Net Profit	3,456	5,172	8,448	8,685	8,095	9,651	14,606	4,280	8,604	7,724	11,749	14,773	20,324
EPS (NT$)	4.29	6.43	10.50	10.05	8.86	10.19	15.44	4.52	9.04	7.68	10.97	13.80	18.98
EPS (NT$) - diluted	4.17	6.12	10.19	10.05	8.86	10.14	15.36	4.52	9.04	7.68	10.97	13.80	18.98
Margins (%)													
Gross Margin	15.2	16.3	22.1	22.7	20.3	19.7	23.3	18.1	18.9	19.8	20.8	21.8	23.1
Operating Margin	5.6	7.9	12.6	12.3	10.8	10.2	13.1	6.1	6.7	7.6	9.3	10.8	12.6
Net Margin	4.2	4.7	7.2	7.2	6.2	6.2	8.5	2.8	5.0	4.2	5.7	6.0	6.9
Sequential Growth (%)													
Revenue	(4)	33	8	2	9	18	11	(12)	13	6	12	21	18
Gross Profit	(24)	42	46	4	(2)	15	31	(31)	18	11	18	27	25
EBIT	(45)	88	71	(0)	(4)	12	42	(59)	26	20	36	41	38
Net Profit	(55)	50	63	3	(7)	19	51	(71)	101	(10)	52	26	38
EPS (NT$)	(56)	50	63	(4)	(12)	15	51	(71)	100	(15)	43	26	38
EPS (NT$) - diluted	(53)	47	67	(1)	(12)	14	51	(71)	100	(15)	43	26	38

Source: Citi Research Estimates, Company Reports

2368.TW: Fiscal year end 31-Dec — Price: NT$1,250.00; TP: NT$1,500.00; Market Cap: NT$638,162m; Recomm: Buy

Profit & Loss (NT$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Sales revenue	38,952	60,004	94,210	136,636	176,317
Cost of sales	-27,556	-40,321	-59,419	-82,563	-104,209
Gross profit	11,396	19,683	34,792	54,074	72,108
Gross Margin (%)	29.3	32.8	36.9	39.6	40.9
EBITDA (Adj)	**9,118**	**15,327**	**29,863**	**48,719**	**65,019**
EBITDA Margin (Adj) (%)	23.4	25.5	31.7	35.7	36.9
Depreciation	-1,051	-1,284	-2,932	-5,492	-6,825
Amortisation	0	0	0	0	0
EBIT (Adj)	**8,067**	**14,043**	**26,931**	**43,227**	**58,195**
EBIT Margin (Adj) (%)	20.7	23.4	28.6	31.6	33.0
Net interest	78	55	122	272	272
Associates	-340	-79	0	0	0
Non-Op/Except/Other Adj	685	154	50	50	50
Pre-tax profit	**8,490**	**14,173**	**27,103**	**43,549**	**58,517**
Tax	-2,875	-4,567	-8,619	-13,639	-18,353
Extraord./Min.Int./Pref.div.	0	0	0	0	0
Reported net profit	**5,616**	**9,607**	**18,484**	**29,911**	**40,164**
Net Margin (%)	14.4	16.0	19.6	21.9	22.8
Core NPAT	5,616	9,607	18,484	29,911	40,164
Per share data	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**
Reported EPS ($)	11.11	18.98	36.53	59.11	79.37
Core EPS ($)	11.11	18.98	36.53	59.11	79.37
DPS ($)	3.46	5.72	9.41	18.10	29.29
CFPS ($)	10.96	4.60	29.91	64.75	78.63
FCFPS ($)	0.81	-8.71	-4.68	41.03	54.92
BVPS ($)	42.17	66.16	102.69	161.80	241.17
Wtd avg ord shares (m)	487	491	493	493	493
Wtd avg diluted shares (m)	505	506	506	506	506
Growth rates	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**
Sales revenue (%)	29.6	54.0	57.0	45.0	29.0
EBIT (Adj) (%)	57.1	74.1	91.8	60.5	34.6
Core NPAT (%)	59.1	71.1	92.4	61.8	34.3
Core EPS (%)	53.6	70.9	92.4	61.8	34.3
Balance Sheet (NT$m)	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**
Cash & cash equiv.	9,185	18,114	23,481	47,261	82,964
Accounts receivables	13,401	27,001	35,351	39,503	50,479
Inventory	7,900	9,747	11,755	13,139	16,616
Net fixed & other tangibles	12,779	19,121	32,408	38,917	38,372
Goodwill & intangibles	257	284	284	284	284
Financial & other assets	1,062	1,478	1,947	2,179	2,795
Total assets	**44,584**	**75,746**	**105,227**	**141,283**	**191,510**
Accounts payable	8,268	11,029	13,491	15,187	19,450
Short-term debt	2,722	5,937	5,937	5,937	5,937
Long-term debt	4,531	11,875	18,328	21,343	23,538
Provisions & other liab	7,751	13,425	15,506	16,940	20,545
Total liabilities	**23,272**	**42,265**	**53,262**	**59,408**	**69,470**
Shareholders' equity	21,312	33,481	51,965	81,876	122,040
Minority interests	0	0	0	0	0
Total equity	**21,312**	**33,481**	**51,965**	**81,876**	**122,040**
Net debt (Adj)	**-1,931**	**-303**	**784**	**-19,981**	**-53,489**
Net debt to equity (Adj) (%)	-9.1	-0.9	1.5	-24.4	-43.8

Valuation ratios	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
PE (x)	na	65.9	34.2	21.1	15.7
PB (x)	29.6	18.9	12.2	7.7	5.2
EV/EBITDA (x)	69.7	41.6	21.4	12.9	9.2
FCF yield (%)	0.1	-0.7	-0.4	3.3	4.4
Dividend yield (%)	0.3	0.5	0.8	1.4	2.3
Payout ratio (%)	31	30	26	31	37
ROE (%)	29.4	35.1	43.3	44.7	39.4
Cashflow (NT$m)	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**
EBITDA	9,118	15,327	29,863	48,719	65,019
Working capital	-1,129	-8,564	-6,283	-2,638	-7,200
Other	-2,451	-4,437	-8,447	-13,317	-18,031
Operating cashflow	**5,538**	**2,327**	**15,133**	**32,765**	**39,789**
Capex	-5,131	-6,733	-17,500	-12,000	-12,000
Net acq/disposals	-263	-66	1,281	0	0
Other	0	0	0	0	0
Investing cashflow	**-5,394**	**-6,799**	**-16,219**	**-12,000**	**-12,000**
Dividends paid	-1,703	-2,920	-4,803	-9,242	-14,955
Financing cashflow	**1,879**	**14,186**	**6,453**	**3,016**	**2,195**
Net change in cash	**2,023**	**9,714**	**5,366**	**23,780**	**29,983**
Free cashflow to s/holders	**407**	**-4,407**	**-2,367**	**20,765**	**27,789**

For definitions of the items in this table, please click here.

3044.TW: Fiscal year end 31-Dec — Price: NT$459.50; TP: NT$666.00; Market Cap: NT$241,516m; Recomm: Buy

Profit & Loss (NT$m)	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
Sales revenue	65,804	73,399	90,205	104,733	119,308
Cost of sales	-50,516	-54,407	-63,750	-71,612	-80,320
Gross profit	15,288	18,992	26,455	33,121	38,988
Gross Margin (%)	23.2	25.9	29.3	31.6	32.7
EBITDA (Adj)	**14,071**	**16,915**	**23,482**	**28,515**	**32,836**
EBITDA Margin (Adj) (%)	21.4	23.0	26.0	27.2	27.5
Depreciation	-4,340	-4,003	-4,300	-3,790	-3,264
Amortisation	0	0	0	0	0
EBIT (Adj)	**9,731**	**12,912**	**19,182**	**24,725**	**29,572**
EBIT Margin (Adj) (%)	14.8	17.6	21.3	23.6	24.8
Net interest	916	742	814	849	829
Associates	66	-13	0	0	0
Non-Op/Except/Other Adj	284	357	324	344	344
Pre-tax profit	**10,996**	**13,998**	**20,320**	**25,918**	**30,745**
Tax	-2,614	-3,773	-4,864	-6,224	-7,392
Extraord./Min.Int./Pref.div.	0	0	0	0	0
Reported net profit	**8,382**	**10,225**	**15,455**	**19,694**	**23,353**
Net Margin (%)	12.7	13.9	17.1	18.8	19.6
Core NPAT	8,382	10,225	15,455	19,694	23,353
Per share data	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**
Reported EPS ($)	15.95	19.45	29.40	37.47	44.43
Core EPS ($)	15.95	19.45	29.40	37.47	44.43
DPS ($)	10.30	12.64	19.11	24.35	31.03
CFPS ($)	23.19	22.39	22.42	43.63	45.98
FCFPS ($)	18.78	11.22	15.19	36.78	39.13
BVPS ($)	95.69	102.90	119.66	138.01	158.09
Wtd avg ord shares (m)	526	526	526	526	526
Wtd avg diluted shares (m)	526	526	526	526	526
Growth rates	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**
Sales revenue (%)	11.8	11.5	22.9	16.1	13.9
EBIT (Adj) (%)	46.9	32.7	48.6	28.9	19.6
Core NPAT (%)	38.3	22.0	51.2	27.4	18.6
Core EPS (%)	38.3	22.0	51.2	27.4	18.6
Balance Sheet (NT$m)	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**
Cash & cash equiv.	28,914	26,659	29,369	38,723	47,001
Accounts receivables	20,389	22,958	28,419	31,371	35,417
Inventory	8,590	12,019	14,427	14,979	17,092
Net fixed & other tangibles	25,077	28,534	28,034	27,845	28,181
Goodwill & intangibles	0	0	0	0	0
Financial & other assets	4,593	7,991	9,447	10,236	11,161
Total assets	**87,564**	**98,162**	**109,695**	**123,154**	**138,852**
Accounts payable	7,119	9,334	9,414	10,628	12,295
Short-term debt	7,142	6,479	7,668	7,726	8,169
Long-term debt	0	1,000	1,184	1,192	1,261
Provisions & other liab	22,999	27,257	28,529	31,059	34,026
Total liabilities	**37,260**	**44,070**	**46,794**	**50,605**	**55,751**
Shareholders' equity	50,296	54,084	62,893	72,541	83,093
Minority interests	8	8	8	8	8
Total equity	**50,304**	**54,092**	**62,901**	**72,549**	**83,101**
Net debt (Adj)	**-21,772**	**-19,180**	**-20,517**	**-29,805**	**-37,571**
Net debt to equity (Adj) (%)	-43.3	-35.5	-32.6	-41.1	-45.2

Valuation ratios	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E
PE (x)	28.8	23.6	15.6	12.3	10.3
PB (x)	4.8	4.5	3.8	3.3	2.9
EV/EBITDA (x)	15.8	12.9	9.3	7.5	6.3
FCF yield (%)	4.1	2.4	3.3	8.0	8.5
Dividend yield (%)	2.2	2.8	4.2	5.3	6.8
Payout ratio (%)	65	65	65	65	70
ROE (%)	17.9	19.6	26.4	29.1	30.0
Cashflow (NT$m)	**2024**	**2025**	**2026E**	**2027E**	**2028E**
EBITDA	14,071	16,915	23,482	28,515	32,836
Working capital	-536	-2,461	-7,973	-549	-2,450
Other	-1,348	-2,687	-3,727	-5,031	-6,219
Operating cashflow	**12,187**	**11,767**	**11,782**	**22,934**	**24,167**
Capex	-2,316	-5,867	-3,800	-3,600	-3,600
Net acq/disposals	0	0	0	0	0
Other	-1,408	-2,971	0	0	0
Investing cashflow	**-3,724**	**-8,838**	**-3,800**	**-3,600**	**-3,600**
Dividends paid	-3,942	-5,414	-6,646	-10,046	-12,801
Financing cashflow	**-181**	**-5,184**	**-5,273**	**-9,980**	**-12,289**
Net change in cash	**8,283**	**-2,255**	**2,710**	**9,355**	**8,278**
Free cashflow to s/holders	**9,871**	**5,900**	**7,982**	**19,334**	**20,567**

For definitions of the items in this table, please click here.

4958.TW: Fiscal year end 31-Dec

Price: NT$315.00; TP: NT$180.00; Market Cap: NT$337,238m; Recomm: Sell

Profit & Loss (NT$m)	2023	2024	2025E	2026E	2027E
Sales revenue	151,398	171,664	182,522	205,104	248,121
Cost of sales	-123,939	-139,203	-146,385	-162,514	-193,938
Gross profit	27,459	32,461	36,136	42,591	54,183
Gross Margin (%)	18.1	18.9	19.8	20.8	21.8
EBITDA (Adj)	**24,989**	**28,781**	**31,992**	**44,051**	**66,785**
EBITDA Margin (Adj) (%)	16.5	16.8	17.5	21.5	26.9
Depreciation	-15,829	-17,195	-18,061	-25,074	-40,053
Amortisation	0	0	0	0	0
EBIT (Adj)	**9,160**	**11,586**	**13,932**	**18,977**	**26,732**
EBIT Margin (Adj) (%)	6.1	6.7	7.6	9.3	10.8
Net interest	575	601	374	610	-440
Associates	-16	3	-17	-16	-16
Non-Op/Except/Other Adj	329	2,855	-227	900	860
Pre-tax profit	**10,048**	**15,045**	**14,063**	**20,470**	**27,136**
Tax	-2,524	-2,524	-2,524	-3,923	-6,329
Extraord./Min.Int./Pref.div.	-3,243	-3,917	-3,815	-4,799	-6,034
Reported net profit	**4,280**	**8,604**	**7,724**	**11,749**	**14,773**
Net Margin (%)	2.8	5.0	4.2	5.7	6.0
Core NPAT	4,280	8,604	7,724	11,749	14,773
Per share data	**2023**	**2024**	**2025E**	**2026E**	**2027E**
Reported EPS ($)	4.52	9.04	7.68	10.97	13.80
Core EPS ($)	4.52	9.04	7.68	10.97	13.80
DPS ($)	4.85	7.55	2.89	4.39	5.52
CFPS ($)	34.07	27.59	28.33	46.46	56.28
FCFPS ($)	6.91	10.51	-4.55	-28.26	9.57
BVPS ($)	101.05	113.75	115.81	124.64	134.05
Wtd avg ord shares (m)	947	952	1,006	1,071	1,071
Wtd avg diluted shares (m)	947	952	1,006	1,071	1,071
Growth rates	**2023**	**2024**	**2025E**	**2026E**	**2027E**
Sales revenue (%)	-11.6	13.4	6.3	12.4	21.0
EBIT (Adj) (%)	-59.2	26.5	20.2	36.2	40.9
Core NPAT (%)	-70.7	101.0	-10.2	52.1	25.7
Core EPS (%)	-70.6	100.0	-15.1	43.0	25.7
Balance Sheet (NT$m)	**2023**	**2024**	**2025E**	**2026E**	**2027E**
Cash & cash equiv.	61,421	79,502	71,116	24,581	31,820
Accounts receivables	29,229	30,183	31,412	22,818	24,699
Inventory	15,508	17,990	19,616	20,251	23,462
Net fixed & other tangibles	125,242	129,940	145,607	200,533	210,480
Goodwill & intangibles	0	0	0	0	0
Financial & other assets	11,376	8,379	12,291	13,139	14,201
Total assets	**242,776**	**265,993**	**280,043**	**281,322**	**304,662**
Accounts payable	19,567	21,716	23,501	20,810	21,735
Short-term debt	35,103	23,040	25,689	33,118	34,792
Long-term debt	18,026	34,012	26,430	5,000	5,000
Provisions & other liab	35,753	35,202	33,710	37,426	42,061
Total liabilities	**108,450**	**113,970**	**109,330**	**96,354**	**103,587**
Shareholders' equity	95,698	108,818	123,982	133,438	143,511
Minority interests	38,628	43,205	46,731	51,530	57,564
Total equity	**134,326**	**152,024**	**170,713**	**184,967**	**201,075**
Net debt (Adj)	**-8,291**	**-22,451**	**-18,997**	**13,537**	**7,972**
Net debt to equity (Adj) (%)	-6.2	-14.8	-11.1	7.3	4.0

Valuation ratios	2023	2024	2025E	2026E	2027E
PE (x)	69.7	34.8	41.0	28.7	22.8
PB (x)	3.1	2.8	2.7	2.5	2.3
EV/EBITDA (x)	14.5	12.5	11.1	8.6	5.9
FCF yield (%)	2.2	3.3	-1.4	-9.0	3.0
Dividend yield (%)	1.5	2.4	0.9	1.4	1.8
Payout ratio (%)	107	84	38	40	40
ROE (%)	4.4	8.4	6.6	9.1	10.7
Cashflow (NT$m)	**2023**	**2024**	**2025E**	**2026E**	**2027E**
EBITDA	24,989	28,781	31,992	44,051	66,785
Working capital	5,659	-1,287	-1,071	5,268	-4,168
Other	1,614	-1,229	-2,414	422	-2,369
Operating cashflow	**32,262**	**26,265**	**28,507**	**49,742**	**60,249**
Capex	-25,719	-16,257	-33,083	-80,000	-50,000
Net acq/disposals	0	0	0	0	0
Other	-1,057	-296	-5,353	16	16
Investing cashflow	**-26,775**	**-16,553**	**-38,436**	**-79,984**	**-49,984**
Dividends paid	-7,635	-4,595	-7,221	-3,089	-4,699
Financing cashflow	**691**	**8,368**	**1,544**	**-16,293**	**-3,026**
Net change in cash	**6,177**	**18,081**	**-8,386**	**-46,536**	**7,239**
Free cashflow to s/holders	**6,543**	**10,008**	**-4,577**	**-30,258**	**10,249**

For definitions of the items in this table, please click here.

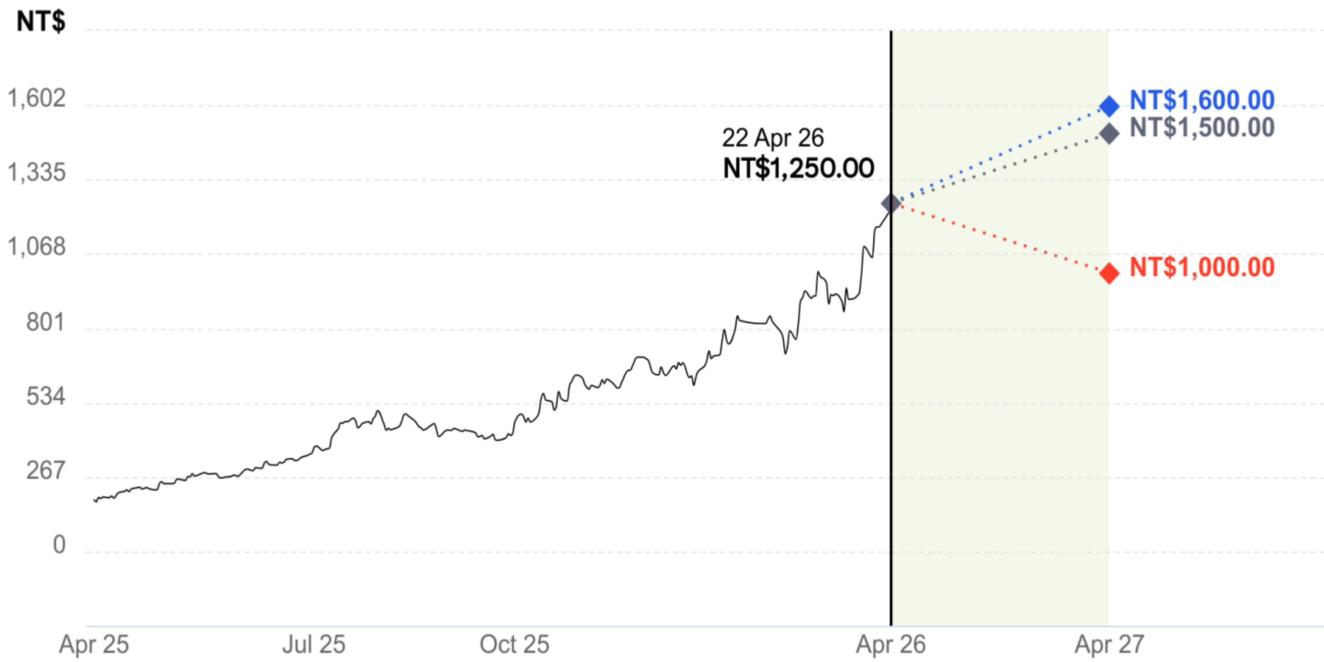
Adding Upside 30-Day Catalyst Watch on Tripod Technology (3044.TW)

Direction:	**Upside**
Duration:	Within 30 Days
Catalyst:	Earnings

We see upside potential to its 1Q26 results (May 8th) and full-year guidance given that 1Q26 sales tracked 7% ahead of our initial/consensus forecasts.

Bull/Bear: Gold Circuit Electronics (2368.TW)

NT$1,600.00	NT$1,500.00	NT$1,000.00
▲28% Upside	▲20% Upside	▼20% Downside



Spread 48pp
Current Price and expected returns (upside/downside) as of 22 Apr 2026

BULL Assumptions

- Penetration into more switch board/UBB/OAM businesses of US CSPs.
- Better efficiency of its Thailand plant.

BASE Assumptions

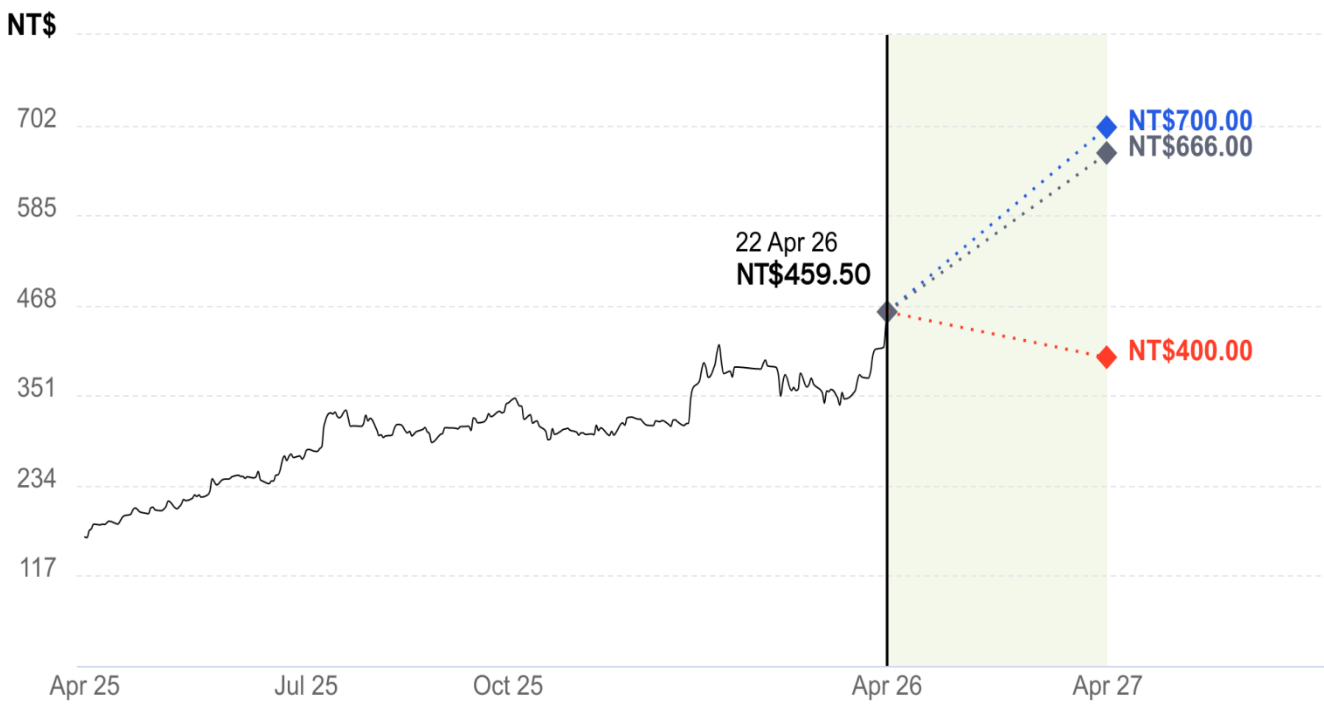
- Revenue YoY growth of +57%/+45% in 2026/27E.
- GM at 36.9%/39.6% in 2026/27E.

BEAR Assumptions

- Share loss to its peers in switch board/UBB/OAM businesses of US CSPs.
- Poor efficiency of its Thailand plant.

Bull/Bear: Tripod Technology (3044.TW)

NT$700.00	NT$666.00	NT$400.00
▲52% Upside	▲45% Upside	▼13% Downside



Spread 65pp
Current Price and expected returns (upside/downside) as of 22 Apr 2026

BULL Assumptions

- Better-than-expected demand recovery across the board

BASE Assumptions

- Revenue YoY at +23%/+16% in 2026E/27E
- Gross margins at 29.3%/31.6% in 2026E/27E

BEAR Assumptions

- Slower than expected demand recovery

Bull/Bear: Zhen Ding Technology (4958.TW)

NT$ 330.00 ▲4.8% Upside	NT$180.00 ▼43% Downside	NT$140.00 ▼56% Downside

Spread 60pp
Current Price and expected returns (upside/downside) as of 22 Apr 2026

BULL Assumptions

- Stronger market share gains in SLP/HDI
- More progress in AI business, especially in GB200
- Better ABF demand from China market

BASE Assumptions

- 2026/27E sales growth of +12%/+21% YoY
- 2026/27E GM of 20.8%/21.8%

BEAR Assumptions

- Harsher margin dilution from stronger capex
- Worse-than-expected ABF demand from China market

Gold Circuit Electronics

Company description

Founded in 1981, Gold Circuit Electronics (GCE) is a Taiwanese company specializing in the production of printed circuit board (PCB) including double-sided PCB, multi-layer PCB, and HDI. GCE's products primarily focus on applications of servers, networking, laptops, base stations, mobile phones, and tablets. The company is known for its high-layer count design capabilities (maximum layer count: +50L) in the PCB industry, which help it to penetrate into more high-end applications such as AI servers and 400G networking. Currently, server/networking accounts for +70% of its total sales. The company has four plants, with one located in Taiwan and the other three in China, and plans to build one plant in Thailand.

Investment strategy

We rate GCE a Buy as we believe its high-tech capabilities in server/networking design will allow it to catch more AI opportunities from US CSPs or US IC designers in the AI boom cycle. We expect its rising sales exposure toward high-end applications with better margins and improving UTR to drive its margin going forward. In our view, geopolitical tensions should benefit non-China suppliers more, which would prevent GCE from fierce ASP competition from China PCB peers.

Valuation

Our TP of NT$1,500 for GCE is based on 25x our 2027E EPS estimate, which is higher than 22x or +2std level of its 1-year-forward PE over the past three years. We believe the 25x multiple is justified by GCE's high AI server/networking sales exposure, market share gain in existing ASIC customer and new AI ASIC customer wins from 2026, which drives its AI ASIC sales growth and margin profile. Recall that TSMC expects close to a 50%+ CAGR in the next five years for its AI-related demand, which is stronger than any other applications. Thus, we believe investors would be willing to pay for high-growth AI names (especially ASIC) with high PE multiples. Our target price is equivalent to 41x/25x our 2026/27E EPS estimates and 14.7x/9.4x our 2026/27E BVPS.

Risks

Key downside risks that could prevent the shares from reaching our target price include: 1) weaker-than-expected server recovery; 2) slower ramp-up pace of new server platform; 3) less-than-expected AI demand; 4) more PCB peers added into AI supply chain; and 5) stricter practice of China+1 by customers due to geopolitical concerns.

Tripod Technology

Company description

Established in 1997, Tripod is a major printed circuit board (PCB) supplier, ranked No.9 globally by Prismark in 2025. Tripod has manufacturing sites in

Taiwan and Wuxi, China. The company has a diversified product portfolio including DRAM, TFT-LCD, HDD, HDI, PC, server, and automotive.

Investment strategy

We rate Tripod a Buy. We like Tripod for its management quality, solid execution, and product-mix improvement. We believe resilient growth from memory, server/networking, and auto businesses will offset soft demand from PCs/handsets and improve the overall margin profile at the same time. Increasing contribution from HDI products should also help margins. With prudent capex, stable depreciation level, and solid operations, we expect the PCB business to generate cash flow to support a decent dividend yield. With AI demand booming and potential supply tightness in high-end PCBs, we believe Tripod could benefit.

Valuation

We use DCF methodology to derive our target price of NT$666. Key assumptions of our DCF model include a risk-free rate of 4.3% (10-year government bond rate), a market risk premium of 7%, and an equity beta of 0.8 (1-year weekly share price), which derives a WACC of 9.6%. Our model assumes c.2% long-term revenue growth and gradually rising EBIT margin from 23.6% in 2027E. Our target price is equivalent to 23x/18x our 2026/27E EPS estimates and 5.6x/4.8x our 2026/27E BVPS estimates, which we believe are more reflective of its current fundamentals.

Risks

Key downside risks that could prevent Tripod shares from reaching our target price are: 1) weaker-than-expected tech demand; 2) increasing China labor costs, rising gold/copper prices, and/or RMB appreciation, which would pressure margins; 3) a sustained drop in conventional PCB pricing; 4) less HDI sales mix; 5) less server/networking/memory sales exposure; and 6) less-than-expected AI growth.

Zhen Ding Technology

Company description

Established in 2006 and headquartered in Shenzhen China, Zhen Ding Technology (ZDT) is one of the world's key flexible PCB makers. ZDT's manufacturing sites are all in China: Shenzhen, Qinhuangdao, Yingkou and Huai'an. ZDT manufactures flexible PCB, HDI, conventional PCB and substrates. FPCB accounts for >50% of revenue, HDI for around 20%, and conventional PCB for the rest.

Investment strategy

We rate ZDT shares as Sell. We think that Apple, to which Zhen Ding has close to 70% sales exposure, will not be able to avoid the impact of tariff/macro uncertainty and limited upside from 2H25. For BT substrate, although ZDT's BT substrate might benefit from potential price hikes, we believe the small sales mix (c.4%) is unlikely to offset the mild smartphone demand in the short term.

Valuation

We set a DCF-based target price for ZDT of NT$180. We use a DCF-based valuation to reflect ZDT's capability to generate stable cash flows. Key assumptions of our DCF model include a risk-free rate of 4.3% (10-year government bond rate), a market risk premium of 7%, and an equity beta of 0.89 (1-year weekly share price), which derived a WACC of 9.7%. Our model assumes high-single-digit long-term growth after 2028E and a 12.6% EBIT margin from 2028E with a gradual annual decline. Our target price is equivalent to 16x/13x 2026E/27E EPS and 1.4x/1.3x 2026E/27E BVPS.

Risks

Key upside risks that could cause the stock to trade above our target price include: 1) better-than-expected iPhone/Mac/iPad end-demand; 2) rising content value for new smartphone models; 3) ZDT gaining market share from its FPC peers; 4) a stronger recovery in the substrate industry; 5) passing the qualifications of major AI GPU or ASIC customers.

If you are visually impaired and would like to speak to a Citi representative regarding the details of the graphics in this document, please call USA 1-888-500-5008 (TTY: 711), from outside the US +1-210-677-3788

Appendix A-1

ANALYST CERTIFICATION

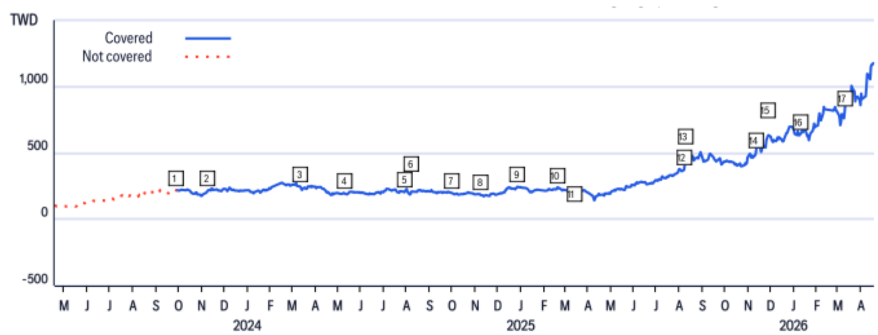
The research analysts primarily responsible for the preparation and content of this research report are either (i) designated by "AC" in the author block or (ii) listed in bold alongside content which is attributable to that analyst. If multiple AC analysts are designated in the author block, each analyst is certifying with respect to the entire research report other than (a) content attributable to another AC certifying analyst listed in bold alongside the content and (b) views expressed solely with respect to a specific issuer which are attributable to another AC certifying analyst identified in the price charts or rating history tables for that issuer shown below. Each of these analysts certify, with respect to the sections of the report for which they are responsible: (1) that the views expressed therein accurately reflect their personal views about each issuer and security referenced and were prepared in an independent manner, including with respect to Citigroup Global Markets Inc. and its affiliates; and (2) no part of the research analyst's compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed by that research analyst in this report.

IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES

Gold Circuit Electronics (2368.TW)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Jack Chen



	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	28-Sep-23 03:46:01	*1	*270.00	219.50
2	09-Nov-23 13:43:33	1	*275.00	215.00
3	12-Mar-24 09:50:59	1	*280.00	242.50
4	09-May-24 19:40:33	1	*270.00	198.50
5	29-Jul-24 14:25:02	1	*280.00	204.00
6	07-Aug-24 10:24:15	1	*285.00	207.00
7	30-Sep-24 06:13:16	1	*290.00	198.00
8	07-Nov-24 16:47:02	1	*275.00	188.50
9	27-Dec-24 08:55:33	1	*300.00	244.50
10	18-Feb-25 12:07:53	1	*305.00	236.50
11	13-Mar-25 10:30:00	1	*310.00	217.00
12	07-Aug-25 13:42:52	1	*450.00	372.00
13	08-Aug-25 10:05:38	1	*500.00	409.00
14	11-Nov-25 09:42:04	1	*600.00	498.50
15	26-Nov-25 12:21:53	1	*750.00	610.00
16	09-Jan-26 12:27:10	1	*820.00	637.00
17	10-Mar-26 19:51:47	1	*1,100.00	817.00

*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Tripod Technology (3044.TW)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Jack Chen

	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	10-May-23 06:10:50	*3	*100.00	109.50
2	08-Aug-23 20:44:47	*1	*220.00	171.50
3	28-Sep-23 03:46:01	1	*280.00	192.50
4	09-Nov-23 13:43:33	1	*290.00	186.50
5	29-Feb-24 08:49:02	1	*280.00	208.00
6	08-Aug-24 09:48:06	1	*290.00	196.50
7	07-Nov-24 16:47:02	1	*280.00	200.50
8	11-May-25 20:26:29	1	*260.00	195.00
9	17-Jun-25 05:18:52	1	*300.00	227.00
10	07-Aug-25 13:42:52	1	*370.00	285.00
11	23-Jan-26 02:58:31	1	*500.00	360.50
12	05-Mar-26 07:40:59	1	*600.00	367.50

*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Zhen Ding Technology (4958.TW)

Ratings and Target Price History
Fundamental Research

Analyst: Jack Chen

#	Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1	10-May-23 14:00:28	1	*130.00	114.00
2	09-Aug-23 14:34:54	1	*120.00	105.00
3	01-Apr-24 14:07:45	1	*180.00	126.50
4	11-Mar-25 14:42:34	1	*150.00	113.50
5	13-May-25 13:56:39	1	*127.00	104.50
6	12-Aug-25 21:00:15	1	*170.00	147.00
7	10-Oct-25 03:35:47	*3	*150.00	166.00

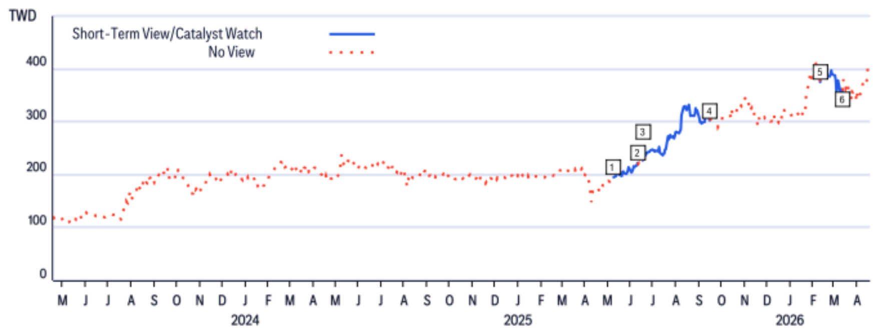
*Indicates Change

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Tripod Technology (3044.TW)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Jack Chen



#	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	11-May-25 16:26:29	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	195.00
2	10-Jun-25 21:36:01	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	222.00
3	17-Jun-25 01:18:52	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	227.00
4	15-Sep-25 21:48:08	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	302.50
5	10-Feb-26 03:24:09	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	375.00
6	12-Mar-26 21:46:30	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	359.00

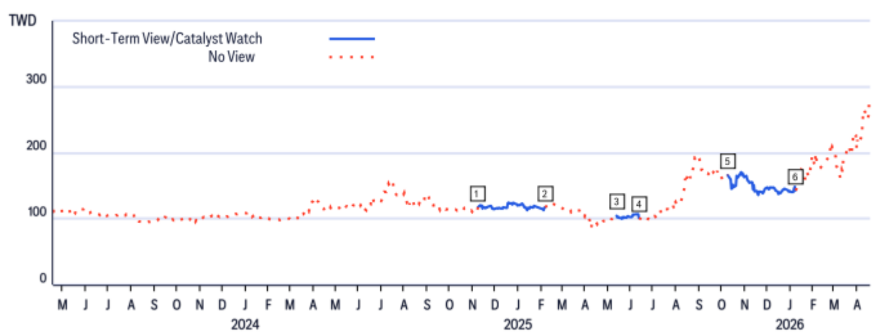
CW - Catalyst Watch , STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Zhen Ding Technology (4958.TW)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Jack Chen



#	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	08-Nov-24 08:14:31	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	117.50
2	06-Feb-25 19:44:32	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	117.50
3	13-May-25 09:56:39	Add STV	Downside	30 Days	104.50
4	12-Jun-25 21:35:38	Remove STV	Downside	30 Days	101.00
5	09-Oct-25 23:35:47	Add CW	Downside	90 Days	166.00
6	08-Jan-26 19:58:49	Remove CW	Downside	90 Days	143.00

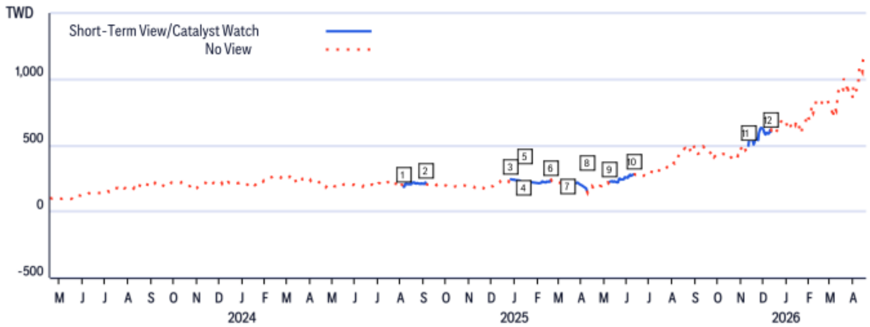
CW - Catalyst Watch , STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Gold Circuit Electronics (2368.TW)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Jack Chen



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	05-Aug-24 02:41:35	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	187.00
2	04-Sep-24 21:42:12	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	210.50
3	27-Dec-24 03:55:33	Add STV	Upside	30 Days	244.50
4	13-Jan-25 00:16:57	Remove STV	Upside	30 Days	203.50
5	13-Jan-25 00:16:57	Add CW	Downside	90 Days	203.50
6	18-Feb-25 07:07:53	Remove CW	Downside	90 Days	236.50
7	13-Mar-25 06:30:00	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	217.00
8	08-Apr-25 01:45:16	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	158.00
9	11-May-25 16:26:29	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	226.00
10	10-Jun-25 21:35:53	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	281.50
11	11-Nov-25 04:42:04	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	498.50
12	11-Dec-25 19:37:10	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	603.00

CW - Catalyst Watch , STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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	12 Month Rating			Catalyst Watch		
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% of companies in each rating category that are investment banking clients	38%	41%	28%	42%	37%	36%

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